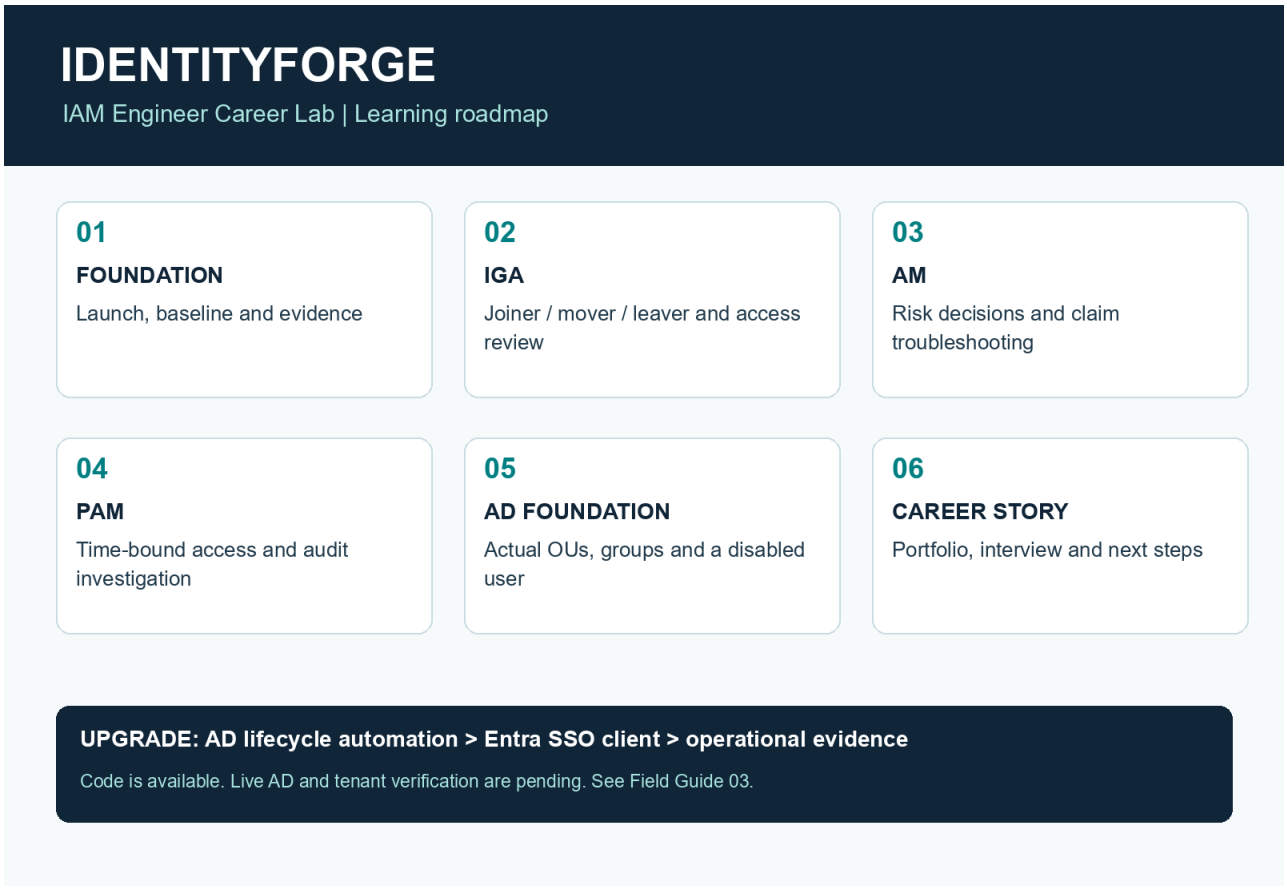
FIELD GUIDE 02 / EVIDENCE TO CAREER STORY

IdentityForge

Roadmap & LinkedIn Playbook

Eight milestones. A clear learning path. Posts grounded in work you can explain.



USE AFTER COMPLETION

These are draft templates, not claims that you have finished. Replace bracketed fields, verify every sentence against your results, and publish only the milestones you actually complete.

LEARNING ROADMAP

Build skill in a defensible sequence

Stage / estimate	Exit evidence	Availability
1. Foundation / 30-45 min	Baseline screenshot; saved evidence folder	Ready
2. IGA / 60-90 min	JML before/after; certification; repeat run	Ready: simulation
3. AM / 60-90 min	Policy cases; corrected claim; flow sketch	Ready: simulation
4. PAM / 60-90 min	Two-hour expiry; session findings; vault design	Ready: simulation
5. AD / setup + 45-90 min	Actual OUs/groups; disabled user; repeat run	Checkpoint 1 ready
6. Hybrid / 45-60 min	Attribute and claim mapping diagram	Design-only worksheet
7. Interview / 60-90 min	Five answers and self-assessments	Ready
8. Capstone / 60-90 min	Curated evidence and honest scope summary	Ready after prior work

Suggested four-week rhythm

Week 1: baseline and IGA. Week 2: AM and PAM. Week 3: prepare an isolated Windows Server lab and complete AD Checkpoint 1 if resources allow. Week 4: optional hybrid design, interview practice and capstone. Estimates are planning suggestions, not promises.

Advanced continuation now available

Field Guide 03 adds CSV-driven AD lifecycle scripts, an Entra MSAL client, operational decisions and a source-bundle exporter. These are implemented locally; live directory and tenant verification remain separate gates. Hybrid synchronization and tiered privileged AD automation are still future extensions.

IMAGE WORKFLOW

Make evidence readable

1. Capture your completed run

Use Windows + Shift + S. Show the result that supports the post: group membership, a policy outcome, a claim-check error, or grant timestamps. Keep one main idea per image.

2. Sanitize before publishing

Crop host paths and personal names. Remove passwords, real tokens, tenant IDs, internal endpoints, recovery codes and actual user data. Use the synthetic lab identities. Review the full image at 100 percent zoom.

3. Assemble a clear image

Use PowerPoint, Canva or another editor. A practical canvas is 1600 x 1100. Add a short title, your verified screenshot, one result and one lesson. The supplied PNG layouts are references: replace their screenshot box with your own image.

4. Label the scope

Use SIMULATION for standalone results, ACTUAL AD LAB for real test-domain work, and DESIGN ONLY for architecture worksheets. Do not fabricate an Entra/Okta portal screenshot or imply a real MFA challenge occurred.

5. Add useful alt text

Describe what is visible and its meaning. Example: Synthetic JIT grant showing start and expiry two hours apart, with access denied at the expiry boundary. Mention only what your image actually demonstrates.

6. Publish after checking facts

Paste the stage template, replace every bracket, attach your image and read it aloud. A concise post with one concrete lesson is stronger than a list of tools you did not use.

MILESTONE 01 / FOUNDATION / STANDALONE

Environment ready

Copy, personalize, then verify

I started IdentityForge, my hands-on IAM learning lab.

My first milestone was establishing a repeatable local environment, checking the synthetic HR and directory baseline, and organizing evidence for each exercise.

The key lesson: successful automation starts with understanding the source of truth and proving the starting state.

Evidence: [describe your verified baseline screenshot]. Next: joiner-mover-leaver governance.

This is a local training simulation using fictional identities.

#IdentityAndAccessManagement #IAM #Cybersecurity #LearningInPublic

IMAGE TO ATTACH

Baseline console showing three directory identities and four HR records. Crop personal paths.

Reflection before posting

What differs between the authoritative HR records and the directory?

Image layout reference: output/images/Milestone-01-Image-Layout.png

MILESTONE 02 / IGA / STANDALONE

Lifecycle under control

Copy, personalize, then verify

IdentityForge milestone: I completed the simulated joiner-mover-leaver workflow.

I mapped department codes to birthright groups, provisioned a missing joiner, removed old Support access during an Engineering transfer, and disabled a terminated identity. I also reviewed conflicting payment privileges and compared before/after evidence.

My verified result: [insert observed result and repeat-run outcome].

The lesson: adding the new role is only half of a mover workflow; old access must be reconciled too.

This exercise used synthetic identities, not a production directory.

#IAM #IdentityGovernance #LeastPrivilege #PowerShell

IMAGE TO ATTACH

Side-by-side before/after directory view plus a cropped certification report. Show only your own completed run.

Reflection before posting

Why must production reconciliation preserve separately approved exceptional grants?

Image layout reference: output/images/Milestone-02-Image-Layout.png

MILESTONE 03 / AM / STANDALONE

Risk-aware access

Copy, personalize, then verify

Today in IdentityForge I tested context-aware access decisions and troubleshot a broken claim mapping.

I evaluated corporate and remote managed-device cases, blocked the high-risk and unmanaged fixtures, and required phishing-resistant MFA in the remote managed-device policy. I then corrected a missing mandatory email claim and retested.

Evidence: [insert your observed policy and claim-check results].

My takeaway: trusted network location cannot overrule a high-risk identity signal.

These were policy and unsigned-token simulations; I did not deploy a live IdP or perform real MFA.

#AccessManagement #ZeroTrust #SSO #IAM

IMAGE TO ATTACH

Policy results with four passing cases, then rejected/accepted claim-check screenshots. Never publish real tokens.

Reflection before posting

Which checks would a real OIDC relying party perform beyond these fixture checks?

Image layout reference: output/images/Milestone-03-Image-Layout.png

MILESTONE 04 / PAM / STANDALONE

Privilege with an expiry

Copy, personalize, then verify

IdentityForge milestone: I demonstrated simulated just-in-time privileged access.

I tested denial before approval, a ticket-backed two-hour grant, and denial at the expiry boundary using the lab clock. I also investigated unapproved database-export and logging-disable events.

Evidence: [describe your deny / allow / expired sequence].

My lesson: expiring an assignment and terminating an existing privileged session are separate controls.

This was a synthetic workflow. No real Domain Admin membership, secure vault, or independent approval system was deployed.

#PrivilegedAccessManagement #PAM #LeastPrivilege #IncidentResponse

IMAGE TO ATTACH

Three panels: denied before grant, approved grant timestamps, and denied at expiry. Add a short audit finding.

Reflection before posting

How would you handle an active session that outlives its role assignment?

Image layout reference: output/images/Milestone-04-Image-Layout.png

Real AD foundation

Copy, personalize, then verify

I extended IdentityForge into an isolated Active Directory lab.

Using the AD PowerShell module, I previewed and created a protected training OU structure, seven global security groups, and a disabled synthetic user with HR attributes. I verified the objects and repeated the build to check that no duplicates appeared.

Evidence: [insert your actual AD verification results].

My takeaway: OUs organize identities; group membership and resource permissions govern access.

This milestone covers an AD foundation only. Entra ID synchronization and Okta integration are not configured.

#ActiveDirectory #WindowsServer #PowerShell #IAM

IMAGE TO ATTACH

Actual Active Directory Users and Computers OU tree, group scope/category output, and disabled lab-alex attributes.

Reflection before posting

Why do local UPN and EmployeeID values not prove cloud synchronization?

Image layout reference: output/images/Milestone-05-Image-Layout.png

MILESTONE 06 / ARCHITECTURE EXERCISE / OPTIONAL

Hybrid identity design

Copy, personalize, then verify

I created a hybrid identity design worksheet for IdentityForge.

I documented the AD source attributes, intended sign-in identifier, application subject/NameID expectations, and the difference between UPN and the configured source anchor. I also compared where Entra ID and Okta would enforce application and authentication policies.

Design artifact: [describe the diagram or mapping worksheet you actually completed].

The lesson: identity correlation and application claims need explicit mapping; changing immutable identifiers is not a shortcut for fixing an SSO loop.

This is a design exercise, not a deployed cloud integration.

#HybridIdentity #MicrosoftEntra #Okta #IAM

IMAGE TO ATTACH

Your own AD-to-IdP-to-application mapping diagram, labeled DESIGN ONLY. No real tenant identifiers or secrets.

Reflection before posting

How do you distinguish sign-in name, application subject and directory source anchor?

Image layout reference: output/images/Milestone-06-Image-Layout.png

MILESTONE 07 / CAREER PREPARATION

Interview practice

Copy, personalize, then verify

I turned my IdentityForge lab notes into interview practice.

I recorded answers to five IAM scenarios covering certification resistance, SSO loops, AM versus IGA, privileged-account compromise, and connector failure during a mover event. I scored technical accuracy, operational sequence, communication, and evidence.

One improvement I made: [insert an actual before/after improvement].

My takeaway: a strong answer explains how to validate the result and handle partial failure, not just which tool to use.

These are training examples; I describe my lab experience accurately.

#IAM #CareerDevelopment #CybersecurityCareers #InterviewPreparation

IMAGE TO ATTACH

A redacted self-score sheet and one short troubleshooting or STAR outline. No invented recruiter feedback.

Reflection before posting

What measured result can you defend from your actual lab evidence?

Image layout reference: output/images/Milestone-07-Image-Layout.png

MILESTONE 08 / VERIFIED ACCOMPLISHMENTS ONLY

Portfolio capstone

Copy, personalize, then verify

I completed my current IdentityForge learning portfolio.

My evidence covers [list only completed stages]: HR-driven lifecycle reconciliation, adaptive policy reasoning, simulated JIT expiry, and [include actual AD foundation only if completed].

My strongest lesson: [insert your own observation]. My next technical goal: [insert a specific, unfinished extension].

Portfolio highlights: [describe two or three artifacts you are sharing].

The standalone exercises are simulations; any actual AD work is identified separately. Cloud integrations remain design-only unless independently implemented and verified.

#IdentityAndAccessManagement #IAM #CybersecurityPortfolio #LearningInPublic

IMAGE TO ATTACH

A carousel: roadmap, IGA outcome, AM outcome, PAM timeline, and actual AD evidence only if completed.

Reflection before posting

Can each public accomplishment be traced to an artifact and a clear scope statement?

Image layout reference: output/images/Milestone-08-Image-Layout.png

OPTIONAL WORKSHEET

Hybrid design without overclaiming

Complete this artifact before using milestone 06. It requires no tenant writes. Read advanced/README.md for the sourceAnchor cautions and Microsoft reference links.

Layer	Document your choice	Validation question
HR / AD	EmployeeID key; Department; lab UPN; alias availability	Is the identity unique and authoritative?
Directory sync	Intended OU scope; configured sourceAnchor; verified sign-in suffix	Could moving an object out of scope delete it in cloud?
Entra ID or Okta	Separate provider configuration; protocol; assignment and sign-in policy	Which product owns each decision?
Application	Expected issuer/audience; subject or NameID format; mandatory claims	Does expected subject match the issued mapping?
Authentication	Managed-device signal; network context; risk priority; MFA requirement	Does high risk override location?
Troubleshooting	Observed loop; correlation IDs; rejected claim; supported correction	Can you prove the cause without changing sourceAnchor?

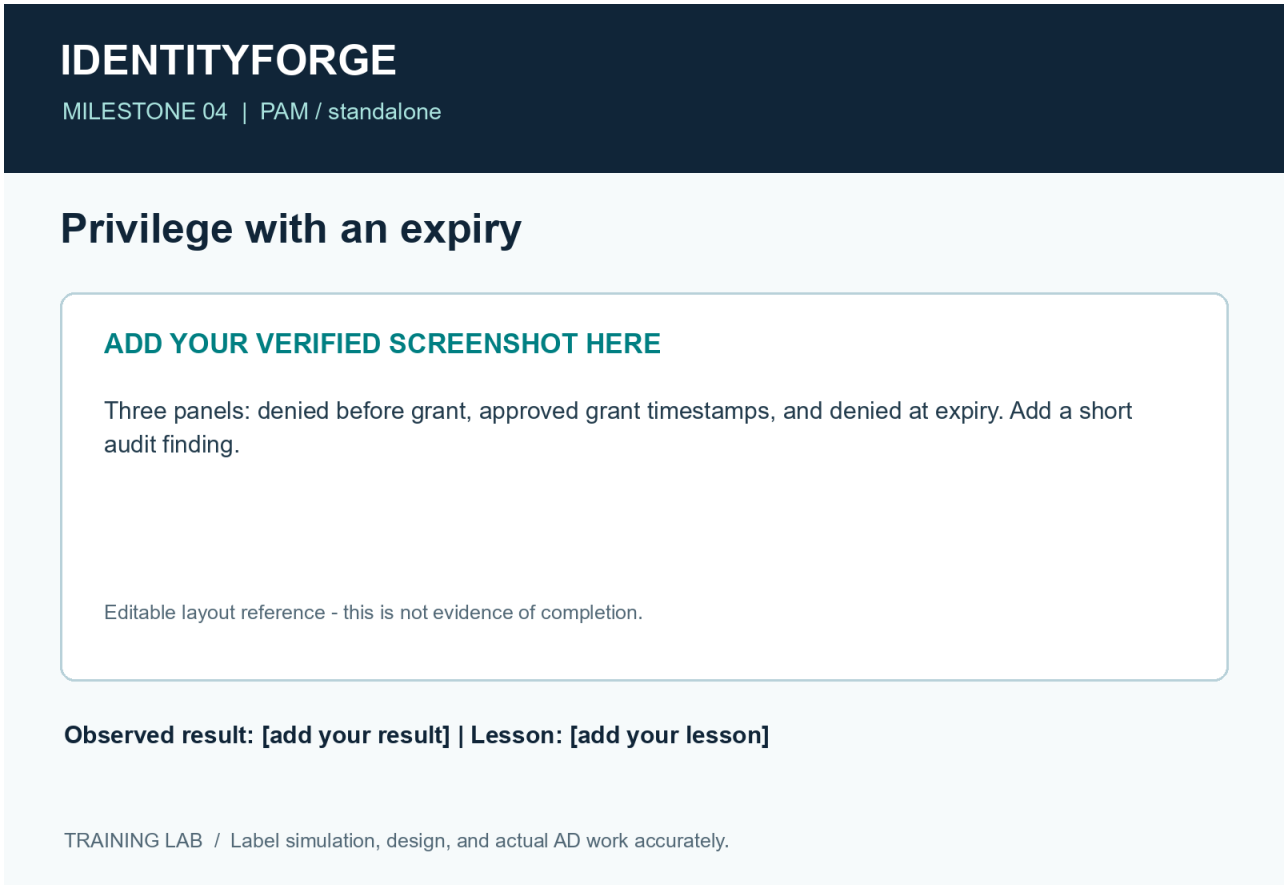
Draw this flow

```
HR -> AD attributes -> [planned sync / matching]
   -> Entra ID or Okta -> SAML / OIDC -> Application
   Label: DESIGN ONLY - not deployed
```

A completed design is an accomplishment. It is different from proving live synchronization, licensing eligibility, MFA enforcement or signed-token validation. Use precise verbs: designed, mapped, compared; reserve deployed and integrated for verified implementations.

PORTFOLIO REVIEW

Ready to share?



Example image-layout reference. Insert your real screenshot in a slide editor; the PNG itself is not an editable screenshot or proof of completion.

Before you publish

[ ] Every stated result is supported by your actual artifact.

[ ] Every bracketed placeholder has been replaced or removed.

[ ] The post distinguishes simulation, actual AD and design-only work.

[ ] Images are readable, sanitized and accompanied by descriptive alt text.

[ ] The capstone links learning to a business problem without inventing employment history.

Professional growth is the story: what you attempted, what you observed, what you corrected, and what you can now explain.